

PROFESSOR AHMED TIJJANI MORA, *OON, mni, FPSN, FPCPharm, FICEN, FIHMN, FNIM*

**A DISTINGUISHED PHARMACIST, ACADEMIC,
PHARMACY REGULATOR, ADMINISTRATOR AND
PUBLIC SERVANT**

Introduction

Professor Ahmed Tijjani Mora, *OON, mni, FPSN, FPCPharm, FICEN, FIHMN, FNIM*, is a distinguished Nigerian pharmacist, academic, pharmacy regulator, pharmaceutical administrator, university administrator and public servant whose professional career spans more than four decades.

Born in the historic city of Zaria, Kaduna State, on 13 May 1956, Professor Mora has built a career that cuts across virtually every major sphere of the pharmacy profession. He has served in hospital, community, industrial and academic pharmacy; held senior positions in government; led the Pharmacists Council of Nigeria (*PCN*); contributed to pharmaceutical regulation and policy development; and served in the governance of universities and professional organisations.

He is currently the Pro-Chancellor and Chairman of the Governing Council of Igbinedion University, Okada (*IUO*), Edo State, where he is also a Professor in the Department of Clinical Pharmacy and Pharmacy Practice and the University's first Professor in that discipline. Igbinedion University's current institutional profile confirms his position as Pro-Chancellor/Chairman of Council.

Early Life and Education

Professor Mora was born into the family of the late Dr. Abdurrahman Mora in Zaria, Kaduna State. He received his secondary education at Barewa College, Zaria,

and subsequently proceeded to Ahmadu Bello University (ABU), Zaria, where he obtained his Bachelor of Science degree in Pharmacy in 1978.

He later obtained a Master of Business Administration (MBA) from Ahmadu Bello University, specialising in Pharmaceutical Marketing. He subsequently earned a Doctor of Philosophy (*PhD*) from Usmanu Danfodiyo University, Sokoto, with a doctoral thesis on Drug Distribution in Nigeria.

His education has been complemented by professional and management training at several institutions, including programmes associated with Harvard University, Liverpool Hope University and the Administrative Staff College of Nigeria (ASCON).

He is also a Member of the National Institute (*mni*), having participated in the Senior Executive Course of the National Institute for Policy and Strategic Studies.

A Pharmacist with Experience across the Four Core Areas of Practice

One of the most remarkable features of Professor Mora's career is the breadth of his professional experience.

He has practised pharmacy across the four principal areas of the profession:

1. Hospital pharmacy;
2. Community pharmacy;
3. Industrial pharmacy; and
4. Academic pharmacy.

This breadth has given him an unusual combination of practical, managerial, regulatory and academic experience.

Hospital and public-sector pharmacy

In Kaduna State, he rose to the position of Director of Pharmaceutical Services in the Kaduna State Ministry of Health.

He also served as Project Manager of the Project Implementation Unit for the African International Development Bank/African Development Fund-assisted Kaduna Health Rehabilitation Project.

These responsibilities exposed him to pharmaceutical procurement, healthcare delivery, management, health-system development and public-sector pharmaceutical administration.

Community pharmacy and pharmaceutical distribution

Professor Mora also made significant contributions to pharmaceutical distribution and community pharmacy.

He served as the Pharmaceutical Divisional Manager of the then Kaduna State Distribution Agency (*KSDA*) and is described by his institutional biography as the first and only pharmacist to occupy that position.

His long-standing interest in pharmaceutical distribution eventually informed his doctoral research on Drug Distribution in Nigeria, an area that has remained central to his professional and academic interests.

Industrial Pharmacy

His industrial experience includes serving as Managing Director/Chief Executive Officer of Zaria Pharmaceutical Company (ZPC) Ltd., Zaria, associated with the manufacture of *ZARINJECT* brand of disposable syringes and needles and the biggest capacity in West Africa.

He was also the *MD* and *CEO* of Zazzau Pharmaceutical Industries Ltd (*ZPIL*) also in Zaria, Kaduna State where he manufactured about ten (10) Pharmaceutical products comprising of tablets and syrups